

# Dean Graham

## Sales enablement portfolio

Newcastle upon Tyne · 07775 503215 · [mrdeangraham@gmail.com](mailto:mrdeangraham@gmail.com) · [linkedin.com/in/mrdeangraham](https://www.linkedin.com/in/mrdeangraham)

Eleven pieces of work from my time at iplicit, a UK mid-market finance software company, between 2024 and 2026. Each one starts with the situation, what I built and what it led to, followed by extracts from the material itself.

Client names, internal targets and colleagues' names have been removed. I'm happy to talk through any of these in more detail.

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### 1 SDR onboarding programme

Twelve weeks in three phases, from new starter to fully ramped

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### 2 Qualification question bank

What to ask a prospect, and why each answer matters

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### 3 Partner cheat sheet and confidence kit

Positioning and referral messaging for accountancy and reseller partners

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### 4 Pitch deck, buyer personas and AI deck builder

A problem-first deck, tailored by industry and buyer

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### 5 SDR Soundcheck & Spotlight

A coaching rhythm built on real calls, with a way to measure it

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Case study: data, interviews and call analysis turned into a programme

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An interactive partner tool that turns client confidence scores into ranked gaps

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What an AE must establish at each stage of a deal

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Partner certification redesigned around a hands-on build, from twelve weeks to four

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An e-learning course for every team, with measured results

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# SDR onboarding programme

The iplicit SDR Onboarding Handbook, November 2025

## SITUATION

New SDRs were taking around four weeks to book their first meeting. With the team growing quickly, every new starter needed the same clear route to being fully ramped.

## WHAT I BUILT

A twelve-week programme in three phases: Learn, Prove and Produce. Each month sets out what the new starter will master, what they will do and what “good” looks like by the end of it. Outbound calling starts in week two rather than after training finishes.

## WHAT CHANGED

Time to first meeting fell from four weeks to two, then to four days over about ten more starters. After each one I asked the new hire and their manager what had helped and changed the pacing. Meetings per SDR rose from 6 to 8 a month while the team more than doubled.

FROM THE HANDBOOK

Months 1 and 2 shown

| Month 1 · Learn                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Foundations | Month 2 · Prove                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Results | Month 3 · Produce | Not shown |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|-------------------|-----------|
| <div><div>MONTH 1</div><div>Learn</div><div>Focus: Foundations, confidence, and controlled outbound.</div></div> <div><p>This month is about building your foundations and getting comfortable operating in a real sales environment. You'll learn iplicit's story, product fundamentals, our ICPs, and the problems our prospects face. You'll start outbound early, practice call frameworks, and begin speaking to real prospects. By the end of Month 1, you should be able to confidently explain why organisations choose iplicit, run basic outbound activity without hesitation, and book your first meeting through consistent, well-researched outreach.</p><div><div>WHAT YOU'LL MASTER</div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● iplicit story and product fundamentals</li><li>● ICPs and personas</li><li>● Value proposition: why prospects choose iplicit</li><li>● Research fundamentals and call/email basics</li><li>● Intro to tools: HubSpot, Apollo, Attention.io</li></ul><div><div>WHAT YOU'LL DO</div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Shadow SDRs, AEs, and real customer calls</li><li>● Learn calling frameworks</li><li>● Start early outbound (week 2 onwards)</li><li>● Practice objection handling and call structure</li><li>● Build your first personal prospect list</li></ul><div><div>END-OF-MONTH OUTCOMES</div><div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Can explain iplicit clearly and confidently</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Sends well-researched, relevant outreach</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Handles basic objections with composure</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Books your <b>first meeting</b></div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Demonstrates ownership, resilience, and pace</div></div></div></div></div></div> |             | <div><div>MONTH 2</div><div>Prove</div><div>Focus: Apply skills, deliver results, and improve quality.</div></div> <div><p>Now you turn knowledge into results. This month is about improving call quality, sharpening your messaging, and demonstrating that you can generate pipeline consistently. You'll deliver cleaner handoffs, work closely with AEs, and use tools like Attention.io to improve your conversations. You're expected to show discipline in your daily routines, understand vertical-specific pain points, and hit a steady meeting target. By the end of Month 2, you should be operating with confidence, accuracy, and visible momentum.</p><div><div>WHAT YOU'LL MASTER</div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Advanced outbound execution</li><li>● Persona-specific messaging (CFO, FD, Head of Finance)</li><li>● iplicit's competitive positioning (Sage50/200, Intacct, Xero, Exchequer)</li><li>● Vertical relevance</li><li>● Strong objection handling and call control</li></ul><div><div>WHAT YOU'LL DO</div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Run structured daily prospecting blocks</li><li>● Keep HubSpot pipeline clean and accurate</li><li>● Collaborate with AEs for strong handoffs</li><li>● Review and improve calls using Attention.io</li></ul><div><div>END-OF-MONTH OUTCOMES</div><div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Books <b>consistent meetings (4+ for the month)</b></div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Demonstrates steady call quality and talk track control</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Produces clean, high-quality handoffs</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Applies vertical insights in messaging</div></div></div></div></div></div> |         |                   |           |

## Qualification question bank

SDR Technical Qualification Questions and Explanations

### SITUATION

SDRs were expected to qualify a prospect's technical fit as well as budget, authority, need and timing before passing a meeting to an AE.

### WHAT I BUILT

Twenty-four questions grouped by company structure, current system, stock, functional needs and buying process. Every question comes with a short explanation of why it's worth asking and what the answer tells you. For example, the number of legal entities points straight to consolidation pain.

### WHY IT MATTERS

It turns product strengths into questions a prospect can answer in their own words. SDRs could hold a credible conversation with a finance director without deep product knowledge, and the AE they were paired with started from a clearer picture of the prospect's pain.

### FROM THE QUESTION BANK

Two of five sections shown

#### Company structure & size

These questions help gauge the complexity of the business and whether implicit is a good fit.

- 1 **How many legal entities are there in total?**  
**WHY ASK:** implicit's multi-entity consolidation is a **key strength**. Understanding the number of entities helps determine if the prospect struggles with manual consolidation, intercompany transactions, and reporting across multiple entities.
- 2 **Are all the entities UK based?**  
**WHY ASK:** If entities are international, implicit's multi-currency and multi-jurisdiction capabilities (e.g., handling VAT/GST differences) may be relevant.
- 3 **Where are the entities located?**  
**WHY ASK:** Helps identify whether cross-border operations require compliance with different tax regimes, foreign exchange handling, or localisation needs.
- 4 **How many employees are there within the organization?**  
**WHY ASK:** Determines the scale of the company and whether they need a system that can support multiple users, approval workflows, and automation at scale.
- 5 **How many make up the core finance team?**  
**WHY ASK:** A small finance team often means they need automation and efficiency, whereas a larger team may require complex user permissions and workflow approvals.
- 6 **What's the revenue for the organisation?**  
**WHY ASK:** Revenue size can indicate complexity in reporting needs, financial controls, and whether they are scaling beyond their current system's capabilities.

#### Decision-making & buying process

These questions help assess the prospect's authority, timeline, and budget.

- 18 **What is your role within the business?**  
**WHY ASK:** Helps identify whether the contact is a decision-maker or an influencer within the buying process.
- 19 **Would you be managing the project yourself?**  
**WHY ASK:** Determines if they are responsible for implementation or if there is an IT/finance team involved.
- 20 **Who would have final sign-off?**  
**WHY ASK:** Identifies the economic buyer (MEDDIC methodology) and whether they need to be engaged later in the process.
- 21 **Is there a timeframe you're working on?**  
**WHY ASK:** Helps prioritise leads based on urgency—whether they need a system now or are just exploring options.
- 22 **When is your year-end?**  
**WHY ASK:** Year-end is often when companies look to transition systems to align with financial reporting cycles, making it a key factor in deal timing.
- 23 **Are there any other system providers you're looking at?**  
**WHY ASK:** Knowing competitors in the mix helps frame implicit's differentiation early in the conversation.
- 24 **Is there a formal budget you're working with?**  
**WHY ASK:** Determines affordability and whether pricing could be a barrier, allowing SDRs to navigate objections early.

Questions 7–17 cover current system, stock and functional needs.

# Partner cheat sheet and confidence kit

Partner-facing enablement, December 2025

## SITUATION

Accountancy and reseller partners are often the first to notice when a client has outgrown their finance system. They aren't product experts, though, and won't read long material before a client conversation.

## WHAT I BUILT

Two levels of the same message. A short cheat sheet covering who the product is for, the triggers to listen for, the one-liner, and what to say when asked about price, integration or implementation. A fuller confidence kit with proof points, referral wording and answers to common client worries.

## HOW IT WAS USED

It was built so that every partner tells the same story, whatever their sector or experience. I also used the kit as the basis for a practical hiring exercise, asking learning-content candidates how they would turn it into training partners would use mid-conversation.

## CHEAT SHEET

Sections 6–9

## CONFIDENCE KIT

Section 3

### THE IPLICIT ONE-LINER (MOST IMPORTANT LINE TO MEMORISE)

*"iplicit gives you enterprise-grade capability without enterprise-grade cost, complexity, or timelines."*

## SIGNS A CLIENT IS A STRONG FIT

Partners should immediately lean in when clients mention:

"Month-end takes too long."

"We rely on spreadsheets for consolidation."

"We've outgrown Sage 50 / Xero."

"We need better approvals and controls."

"Our systems don't talk to each other."

"ERP is too big or too expensive."

"We're adding new sites/entities."

"Audits are painful."

"Reporting isn't real-time."

## IF THE CLIENT ASKS ABOUT INTEGRATION

"iplicit is API-first and integrates with the systems you rely on — CRM, EPOS, payroll, TMS, ticketing, stock, expense tools, banking and more. You keep what works; iplicit becomes the finance hub."

## IF THE CLIENT ASKS ABOUT IMPLEMENTATION

*"With one of the fastest implementation times in the market, most customers go live in weeks, not years. UK-based delivery, clear timelines, no ERP-style disruption."*

## Key triggers that say "This client is ready for iplicit"

This section helps you quickly recognise when a client is likely to benefit from iplicit, without needing deep technical knowledge or a detailed discovery process. The triggers highlight the practical signs that an organisation has outgrown its current finance system — whether that's operational strain, manual work, growth pressures, or reporting limitations. Use this list as a simple checklist during your conversations or reviews. If a client shows several of these indicators, it's a strong signal that introducing iplicit will add genuine value to them and strengthen your advisory relationship.

### OPERATIONAL TRIGGERS

8

- ☐ Multi-entity growth or new subsidiaries
- ☐ Heavy Excel use for reporting or consolidation
- ☐ Too much manual month-end work
- ☐ Restricted/unrestricted funds complexity
- ☐ Inventory or project tracking limitations
- ☐ Approval processes happening via email/Teams
- ☐ Bank rec or AP choking the finance team
- ☐ High dependency on "that one person who knows the system"

### TECHNOLOGY TRIGGERS

3

- ☐ They run Xero, Sage 50, QuickBooks, or an ageing on-prem system
- ☐ Need for deeper integrations with CRM, stock, HR, billing
- ☐ Making decisions off delayed / inconsistent data

### BEHAVIOURAL TRIGGERS

3

- ☐ CFO/FD showing frustration with inefficiency
- ☐ Leadership pushing for scalability
- ☐ Team drowning in admin

3

If you spot three, iplicit is a fit and should be scoped

5

If you spot five, it should be an instant referral

# Pitch deck, buyer personas and AI deck builder

Partner sales deck (20 slides) and buyer persona set

## SITUATION

Our team and partners were pitching to finance leaders across very different sectors, from financial services to theatres and hire companies. Each conversation needed the message tailored to that buyer.

## WHAT I BUILT

A deck that starts with the buyer's problem before it gets to the product, with sector pages and sections on implementation, support and security. Behind it sits a set of buyer personas, from CFO to IT director, setting out each one's goals, frustrations and who influences them.

## WHAT CHANGED

I coached reps on running the deck, then built an AI deck builder that produces a pre-approved deck in moments, tailored to the prospect's sales stage, industry and persona. All eight AEs and our three partner account managers used it.

### The Three Problems Holding Mid-Market Finance Teams Back.

THE PROBLEMS BEHIND THE PAIN

1

#### Processes Held Together by Spreadsheets and Workarounds

Finance teams lose hours every month patching holes your legacy system can't handle — manual journals, duplicated data, clunky reporting, and endless re-checking just to stay afloat.

2

#### Stagnant Legacy Systems Blocking Growth

Whether you're stuck on old on-premise tools or outgrowing entry-level software, the outcome is the same: slow reporting, rising costs, painful upgrades, and zero support for multi-entity or complex operations.

3

#### Integration Pain and Never-Ending Projects

Every new system means rewriting rules, rebuilding mappings, and funding bespoke connectors. Projects stall, partners disagree, and nothing ever integrates cleanly.

Leading with the problem

### Bridging the Mid-Market Gap.

THE UK'S LEADING MID-MARKET SOLUTION

iplicit offers a smart alternative — freeing organisations from legacy & entry level software *without* the expense and complexity of traditional ERP solutions.

#### Entry - Level

lego

xero

qb

Price  
Functionality  
Implementation Time

#### Mid-Market

iplicit

Price  
Functionality  
Implementation Time

#### Enterprise

s

oracle

Price  
Functionality  
Implementation Time

Positioning against entry-level and enterprise systems

### Implementation Methodology.

FAST, PREDICTABLE, LOW-FRICTION DELIVERY

1 - Onboard

- Planning
- Project Kick-off
- Introduction to Teamwork

2 - Design

- Sandbox Creation
- Solution Design
- Data Collection

3 - Build

- Build Workshops
- Configuration walkthrough
- QA of Build

4 - Train

- User training sessions

5 - Test

- User acceptance testing
- UAT support
- Readiness to deploy

6 - Deploy

- Provision life system
- Opening Balances
- Go live support

7 - Complete

- Lessons learned
- Project closedown
- Customer Success

Implementation features:

- 22 days on average
- Project manager & access to Teamwork project portal
- Specialist resources dedicated for the life of the project

INDICATIVE TIMELINE

| Week 1             | Weeks 2-3 | Weeks 4-6              | Weeks 7-9              | Weeks 10-12              | Weeks 13-15 | Week 16 |
|--------------------|-----------|------------------------|------------------------|--------------------------|-------------|---------|
| Contract signature |           |                        |                        |                          |             |         |
|                    |           | Completion of Build QA | Completion of Training |                          |             |         |
|                    |           |                        |                        | Completion of Deployment |             |         |

Making implementation feel predictable



### Director of Finance

Joanna  
Level Head, Decision-Maker

#### Responsibilities

At a *small- to medium-sized general business* company with limited resources, the Director of Finance uses their experience to manage complex financial operations, sometimes without any formal accounting training. Budget constraints mean that they often require external accounting help. This limitation also means that, although are technologically savvy regarding adopting new systems, they rely heavily on Excel and manual processes.

In the *not-for-profit* sector the added requirements for complex government grants, funding rules, and compliance stretch an already limited staff and budget. The Director of Finance is frequently a team of one or two, relying on interns and volunteers, and also lacks robust data analysis capabilities, making it difficult and time-consuming

#### Frustrations

- Budget constraints and complex funding & compliance requirements make it hard to prioritize spending
- Reliance on interns and volunteers makes it difficult to cultivate and manage a strong team
- Manual data entry is a constant challenge causing errors, rework, and costly delays
- Limited IT and customer support adds complexity to daily tasks
- Meeting reporting and auditing mandates is difficult due to a lack of modern, integrated general ledger and HR tools

#### Winning Their Business

- Demo comprehensive integrated GL, Reporting, Dashboards, Funds
- Underscore easy integration and setup, and access to testing environments/sandboxes resulting in lower employee training needs
- Show how friendly UI and built-in learning enable employee self-help and development
- Demonstrate FPA tools and dashboards that offer easy snapshots and visualizations of the metrics and data they really need to know
- Point out reliable training and customer support options

#### Decision Making & Influencers

- Own Experience
- Colleagues
- Board
- Professional Forums, Advocacy Groups, Industrial Reports
- Vendors & Consultants
- Google/Internet

Buyer persona: Director of Finance

## SDR Soundcheck & Spotlight

A coaching model and measurement framework for the SDR team

### SITUATION

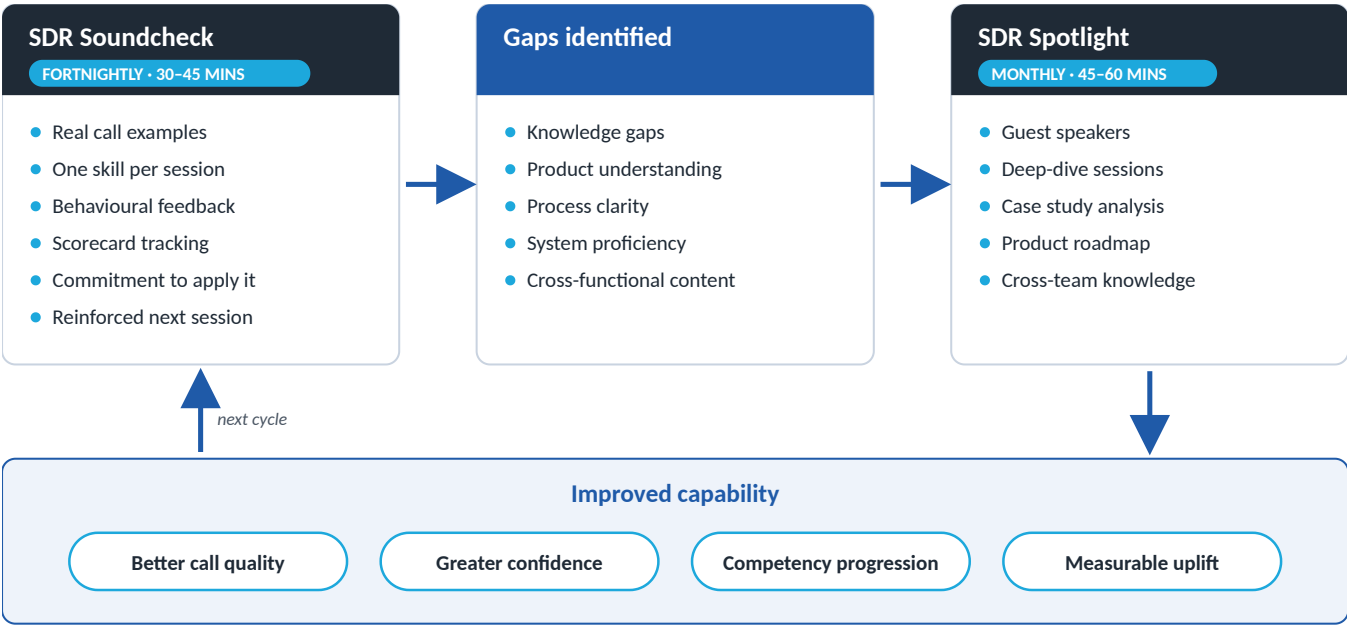
Call listening and team sessions had happened, but not consistently, and they were hard to link to any particular skill gap.

### WHAT I BUILT

A fortnightly Soundcheck: thirty to forty-five minutes on one skill, using real calls, with each SDR committing to try it before the next session. The gaps it surfaced shaped a monthly Spotlight session with guest speakers and deeper dives. Enablement designed the system and SDR leadership ran it.

### WHAT CHANGED

Average call scores across the team rose from 3.2 to 3.8. It was measured with data the team already had in Attention.io and HubSpot, so it added very little admin.



**Designed by**  
Enablement

**Run by**  
SDR team leadership

**Anchored to**  
The SDR competency framework

The Soundcheck & Spotlight cycle

| Measurement layer       | The question it answers                            | Examples of what we tracked                                                              |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Programme health     | Are sessions happening, and are people turning up? | Sessions delivered against plan, attendance, topics covered                              |
| 2. Behavioural adoption | Are SDRs trying what they learned on real calls?   | Commitments completed, examples shared at the next session, scorecard trends by skill    |
| 3. Competency movement  | Are SDRs actually getting better?                  | Call scores by competency before and after eight weeks, using the same method both times |

# Diagnosing an SDR performance gap

Case study, 2026

## THE BRIEF

The SDR team was falling short of its target of 12 meetings per rep per month. I was asked by the leadership team to find out why and design an enablement programme to close the gap.

## WHAT I DID

I combined CRM meeting data, 90 days of call-recording and coaching data, and nine structured interviews with SDRs, team leads, AEs and senior leaders. Every interview followed the same question set, so the answers could be compared.

## WHAT I PROPOSED

Five enablement tracks, each with an owner and a measure, starting with quick wins in week one alongside a 90-day build. I also set out clear requests for the issues that sat with other teams.

## Learning from the top performer

One SDR was consistently booking more meetings than anyone else. Rather than put it down to territory or luck, I compared more than 160 of their calls with nearly 500 calls from the rest of the team. The difference came down to a handful of habits that could be taught, such as opening with a clear reason to talk, layered discovery instead of a script, reframing objections rather than backing down, and owning the next step instead of offering to send an email. I wrote these up as coaching material for the rest of the team.

## Within enablement’s control

- A regular coaching rhythm
- Top-performer habits written down and taught
- A redesigned ramp for new starters
- Foundational call skills

## Needing other teams

- Team lead roles and accountability
- How inbound leads were shared out
- The profile used for hiring
- Brand awareness in some sectors

**Why I include this:** it is how I approach any enablement request. Before building anything, I check what the data and the people closest to the work say the problem really is, and I’m clear about which parts training can fix and which it can’t.

# Finance Gap Finder

Interactive partner tool, rebuilt for this portfolio

## SITUATION

Partners could spot a client who had outgrown their finance system, but turning that into a structured conversation about what to fix depended on product knowledge most of them didn't have.

## WHAT I BUILT

An interactive discovery tool. The partner and the client's finance lead rate their confidence in key finance processes from 0 to 10. Anything scored 6 or below becomes a ranked gap, showing what it costs the client and how iplicit closes it.

## WHAT CHANGED

More than 20 referral, reseller and ISV partners used it with their clients in its first quarter, and it was directly attributed to 8 referrals in that time. Partners had a structured way into discovery without needing to be product experts.

## THE REBUILT TOOL

Example client shown

RECREATION

This is a rebuild of a partner discovery tool Dean Graham originally created at iplicit. The original is no longer accessible, so it has been recreated for his portfolio. Not an official iplicit product.

PARTNER DISCOVERY TOOL

## Where is your client's finance team least confident?

Sit down with the finance lead and rate each process from 0 (not confident at all) to 10 (fully confident). Gaps surface instantly, ranked, with how iplicit closes each one and the question to ask next.

1 Rate confidence

2 Review ranked gaps

3 Copy the summary into your follow-up

Client

Northgate Learning Trust (example)

Current system

Sage 50

Load example

Start fresh

0-3 Critical gap

4-6 Gap

7-10 Confident

RECORD TO REPORT

avg 3.7

Month-end close

We close the month quickly, without late nights or manual journals.

3

0 · Not confident

5

10 · Fully confident

Multi-entity & consolidation

We can consolidate all entities without spreadsheets.

2

45

out of 100

Clear room to improve

Northgate Learning Trust (example) on Sage 50: weakest in purchase invoice processing and multi-entity & consolidation.

6 critical

4 gaps

4 confident

CONFIDENCE BY PROCESS

Purchase invoice processing

Multi-entity & consolidation

Budgeting & forecasting

1

2

2

Confidence is rated process by process, and the overall score and ranking update as each slider moves

HOW IPLICIT CLOSSES THE GAPS · 10

Purchase invoice processing

CRITICAL GAP · 1/10

Manual keying costs hours each week and introduces coding errors.

Purchase invoice automation. Invoices are captured, coded and matched to purchase orders automatically, then routed for approval.

ASK NEXT

Roughly how many supplier invoices do you process a month, and who keys them?

Multi-entity & consolidation

CRITICAL GAP · 2/10

Spreadsheet consolidation is slow, hard to audit and breaks every time the group changes.

Multi-entity by design. Run every entity on one platform with automated inter-entity transactions and consolidated group reporting on demand.

ASK NEXT

How many entities do you report on, and how long does group reporting take each month?

## TRY IT

The original tool is no longer accessible, so I rebuilt it to show how it worked. The rebuild is live and works in any browser:

[dg-my-portfolio.github.io/Enablement/gap-finder.html](https://dg-my-portfolio.github.io/Enablement/gap-finder.html)

- 1 Rate each finance process from 0 (not confident) to 10 (fully confident)
- 2 Review the gaps, ranked from weakest to strongest
- 3 Copy the summary into a follow-up email to the client

Each gap is paired with how iplicit closes it and the next question to ask

# Deal coaching toolkit

The W and the M, mutual action plans and the value map: a package for AEs and SCs, rebuilt for this portfolio

## SITUATION

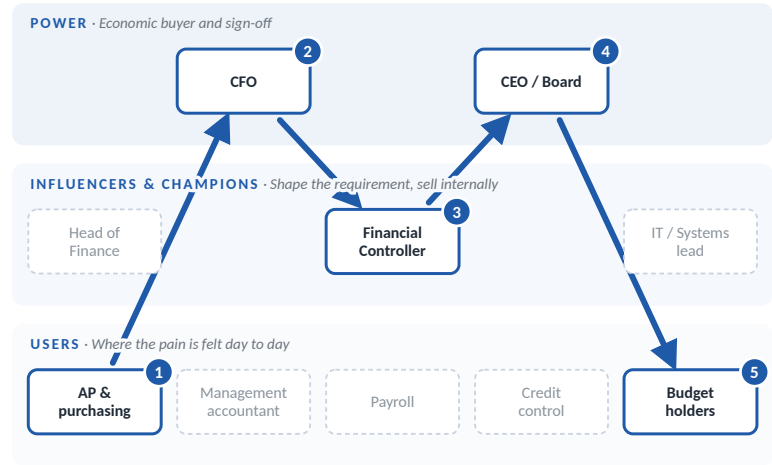
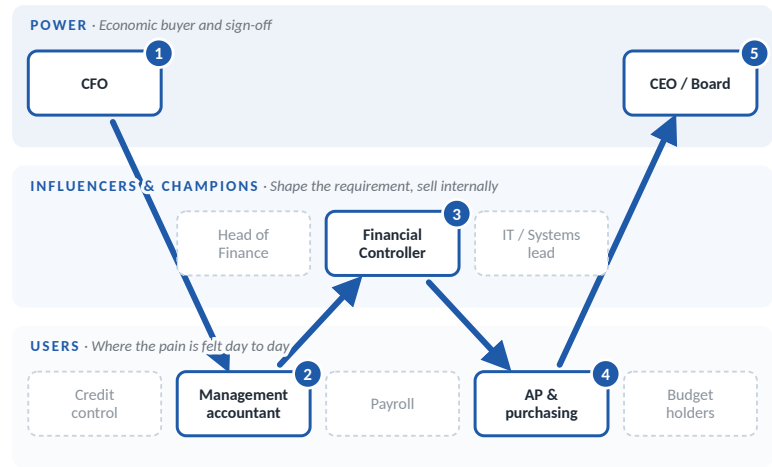
Deals were stalling in ways coaching could fix. 40% of Closed Lost was put down to prospects going quiet, prospects sat through just over three demos each, and too many deals rested on one friendly contact.

## WHAT I BUILT

A coaching package with three tools. The W and the M make multi-threading a shape a rep can draw in a deal review. Mutual action plans turn the end of each call into a dated commitment. The value map keeps demos on the buyer's top problems.

## WHAT CHANGED

In a pilot with two AEs, deals lost because the prospect went quiet fell from 40% to 32% of Closed Lost. With the SC team, demos per prospect fell from just over three to about two.



## W Start with power

**Use it when** you can get to the CFO first, through a referral, partner introduction or event.

- 1 CFO**  
Open at the top. Agree the business problem and get permission to speak to the team.
- 2 Management accountant**  
Go down to the people doing the work and find the detail behind the pain.
- 3 Financial Controller**  
Build your champion. Share what you found and test the case together.
- 4 AP & purchasing**  
Check it with a second user group so the case doesn't rest on one view.
- 5 CEO / Board**  
Return to power with evidence from the team, and the CFO alongside you, to agree sign-off.

## M Start with users

**Use it when** you come in through inbound or outbound with someone who does the work.

- 1 AP & purchasing**  
Start where the pain is felt. It's often the easiest way in.
- 2 CFO**  
Climb early. Take what you've learned to power before the deal settles at the bottom.
- 3 Financial Controller**  
Build your champion, now with the CFO's backing.
- 4 CEO / Board**  
Go back to power with the business case and agree the decision process.
- 5 Budget holders**  
Confirm fit with the wider users and plan adoption.

**THE RULE FOR BOTH**

Never let a deal sit on one level. The W starts with authority and earns the detail. The M starts with the detail and has to earn authority, so make the first climb early.

## Mutual action plans and the value map

Two of the three tools in the deal coaching toolkit

### MUTUAL ACTION PLANS

I piloted them with two AEs. The close of every call became a commitment rather than a hope: next steps, owners, dates and what each step covers, written down with the customer.

### THE VALUE MAP

I worked with the SC team on it, using principles from Command of the Message rather than the formal framework. It sets the scope of every demo before it starts.

### WHAT CHANGED

Deals lost because the prospect went quiet fell from 40% to 32% of Closed Lost in the pilot. Demos per prospect fell from just over three to about two. Two AEs is a small sample, but the direction was clear enough to widen it.

### MUTUAL ACTION PLAN

Example deal, recreated

Agreed with the buyer and shared with them, so both sides can see what happens next, who owns it and when. Every call ends by updating it.

| # | What this step covers                                        | Owner      | When   | Status  |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------|---------|
| 1 | Discovery: agree the problems and what fixing them is worth  | Both       | Wk 1   | Done    |
| 2 | Demo of the agreed problems only, using the value map        | iplicit SC | Wk 2   | Done    |
| 3 | Finance Director reviews the business case with the champion | Buyer      | Wk 3   | Next    |
| 4 | Integration and data review with the buyer's IT lead         | Both       | Wk 4   | Planned |
| 5 | Proposal and commercial terms                                | iplicit AE | Wk 5   | Planned |
| 6 | Procurement and contract review                              | Buyer      | Wk 6–7 | Planned |
| 7 | Signature and implementation kick-off                        | Both       | Wk 8   | Planned |

### VALUE MAP

Example buyer, recreated

Built with the solution consultant before the demo: the buyer's top five problems, how iplicit solves each one, and why that matters to this buyer.

| The buyer's problem                              | How iplicit solves it                                   | Why it matters to them                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Group reporting is stitched together in Excel    | Consolidation across every entity in one click          | The board pack stops depending on one person and a spreadsheet    |
| Month-end takes too long                         | Recurring journals, bank feeds and live ledgers         | Leaders see this month's numbers while they can still act on them |
| Supplier invoices are keyed by hand              | Purchase invoice automation matched to purchase orders  | Hours back each week and fewer coding errors                      |
| Spend is approved by email                       | Approval workflows by value, department or entity       | Spend is controlled before it's committed, not after              |
| Budget-holders wait for finance to build reports | Unlimited analysis dimensions and self-serve dashboards | Finance stops being a report factory                              |

**The demo rule:** show only what solves the agreed problems, unless the prospect asks for more. Demo data is cleaned and made relevant to the prospect before every session.

# MEDDIC by deal stage

What an AE must establish at each stage of a deal, rebuilt for this portfolio

## SITUATION

The CSO's draft mapped MEDDIC to the deal stages only part of the way, and left Competition out. AEs were about to work their live deals through it at a four-day alignment event.

## WHAT I BUILT

Starting from the CSO's draft, I completed it: every element anchored to a stage, Competition added, and live qualifying questions for each. We co-ran the MEDDIC session at the event.

## WHAT CHANGED

AEs certified against it at their three-month probation review, and every AE I onboarded passed. It later fed into the MEDDIC course the Chief Sales Officer commissioned for AEs and SCs.

## MEDDIC BY DEAL STAGE

Five deal stages, recreated

| MEDDIC              | 1<br>Discovery<br>AE, picking up from the SDR   | 2<br>Solution validation<br>AE + SC demo      | 3<br>Executive validation<br>AE                   | 4<br>Negotiation and sign-off<br>AE   | 5<br>Deal won / lost<br>Won: AE hands to project manager |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| M Metrics           | Discovery: what is the pain worth?              |                                               | Validation: the economic buyer agrees the numbers |                                       | Handed to the project manager as success measures        |
| E Economic buyer    | Who signs, and have we met them?                |                                               | Engaged in the decision                           |                                       |                                                          |
| D Decision criteria |                                                 | What good looks like, proven in the SC's demo |                                                   |                                       |                                                          |
| D Decision process  | How they buy: who signs, in what order, by when |                                               |                                                   | Procurement and legal steps completed |                                                          |
| I Implicate pain    | Why act now? The cost of doing nothing          |                                               |                                                   |                                       |                                                          |
| C Champion          | Identify: who gains most if this succeeds?      |                                               | Activate: equipped to make the case without us    | Keeps the deal moving to signature    |                                                          |
| C Competition       |                                                 | Who else, including the status quo            |                                                   |                                       |                                                          |

## QUALIFYING QUESTIONS FOR LIVE DEALS

One of five per element

### M Metrics

Has the FD or EB signed off on the business case numbers — or are they still our numbers, not theirs?

### D Decision criteria

Have they told us what would disqualify a vendor — and do we know where we stand against it?

### I Implicate pain

What happens if they do nothing and stay on their current system for another 12 months?

### C Competition

Is the real competition another vendor, or is it the status quo and the cost of change?

### E Economic buyer

Is the person we're talking to able to say yes, or only able to say no?

### D Decision process

Walk me through how this decision gets made internally — who needs to be involved before anything is signed?

### C Champion

Can they tell us what's being said about us when we're not in the room?

# Partner Build Lab

Partner implementation certification, rebuilt for this portfolio

## SITUATION

Partners learned to implement iplicit by shadowing live projects. Only one partner could shadow each implementation, and it had to be at the right stage, so certification took about as long as a full implementation: around twelve weeks.

## WHAT I BUILT

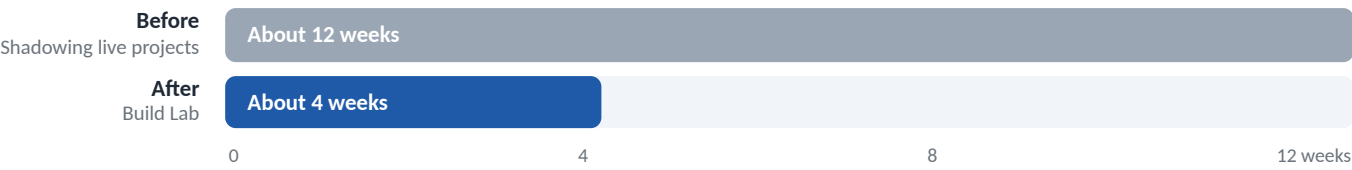
I challenged the idea that more shadowing was the answer and led working groups of implementation specialists, project managers and functional designers. Together we moved the knowledge into self-paced pathways, then a practical build project.

## WHAT CHANGED

Certification fell from about twelve weeks to about four on average, with no drop in standard. Six new partners were certified through it before I left. I reported progress, timelines and blockers to the executive team throughout.

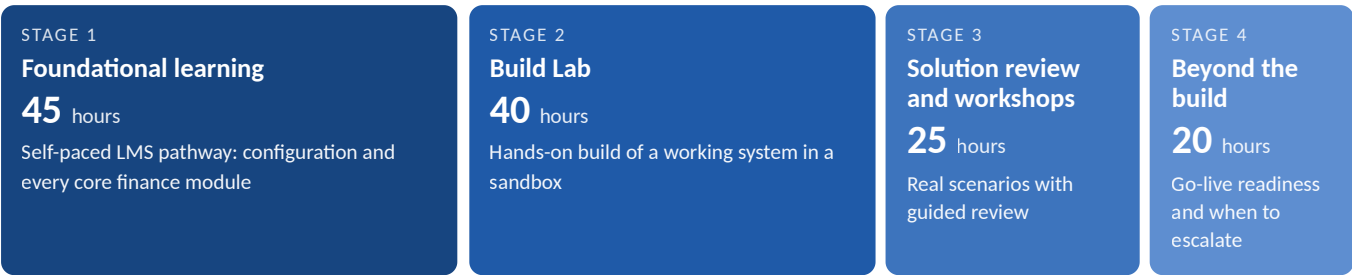
## TIME TO CERTIFICATION

Average per partner



## THE IMPLEMENTATION TRACK

About 130 hours in four stages



Block widths are to scale by hours.

## PATHWAYS BY PARTNER ROLE

Each ends in certification



## HOW PARTNERS WERE ASSESSED

Throughout the programme, then certified on two things: the learning-pathway assessment, and a review by iplicit staff of the partner's own sandbox build.

## WHY THE BUILD MATTERS

Partners prove they can configure the system themselves before they implement it for a client, instead of having watched someone else do it.

# Introduction to Business and Accounting

An e-learning course for every team, rebuilt for this portfolio

## SITUATION

People across iplicit talked to finance buyers every day, but many outside finance had never learned the basics: what a journal is, why a trial balance matters, or the difference between profit and cash.

## WHAT I BUILT

A short course for the whole business in thirteen sections, from double-entry to the accounting cycle. The CFO reviewed the script. My team built it in Articulate Rise with presenter video from Synthesia and walkthroughs in iplicit itself. I owned it and signed it off.

## WHAT CHANGED

Average learner confidence rose from 3.72 to 4.53. 36 of 47 learners said they could now follow customer finance conversations better, and learners across departments agreed it was relevant to their role.

## THE COURSE

13 sections, recreated

### FOUNDATIONS

- 1 Introduction
- 2 What is financial accounting?

### RECORDING TRANSACTIONS

- 3 Double-entry accounting
- 4 The accounting equation
- 5 Identifying transactions
- 6 Journal entries
- 7 Accounts and the general ledger
- 8 Main account types

### CHECKING THE NUMBERS

- 9 Trial balance
- 10 Adjusting entries

### REPORTING

- 11 Financial statements
- 12 Profit vs cash flow
- 13 The accounting cycle

### INSIDE EACH SECTION

Short presenter video

Written explainer

Walkthrough in iplicit

Knowledge check

Section 4 of 13

Knowledge check

#### THE ACCOUNTING EQUATION

Every transaction keeps both sides equal

Assets = Liabilities + Equity

A business buys a £2,000 laptop and pays by bank transfer. What happens?

Assets go up by £2,000

Assets stay the same: equipment up, bank down

Liabilities go up by £2,000

Correct. One asset replaces another, so the equation still balances.

#### WHAT LEARNERS SAID



**36 of 47** learners said they could now follow customer finance conversations better

